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Nasdaq 100 Leads Gains as Tech Stocks Rebound

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The Nasdaq 100 led gains in the US session, driven by a rebound in tech stocks. The `NVDA` stock was a notable performer, rising +3.03%. Key takeaways from the session include:

- The S&P 500 closed at 7,748.50, up +0.26% on the day.
- The VIX fell -4.78% to 14.55, indicating decreased volatility.
- The 10Y yield was down -0.04% at 4.68.

The market's focus will be on the upcoming earnings season, with several major companies set to report. Investors will be watching for signs of strength in the tech sector, as well as any indications of a slowdown in the economy.

The current market environment is characterized by a mix of positive and negative factors. On the one hand, the rebound in tech stocks and the decline in volatility are positive signs. On the other hand, the ongoing concerns about the economy and the potential for a slowdown in earnings growth are negative factors.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE	VIX
S&P 500	7,748.50	+0.26%	14.55
Nasdaq 100	29,742.60	+0.74%	
Dow Jones	53,770.30	-0.04%	
Russell 2000	3,045.48	+0.61%	
10Y Yield	4.68	-0.04%	
WTI Crude	82.16	-1.25%	
Gold	4,465.20	+1.88%	
DXY	100.01	+0.19%	
BTC	63,541.13	-0.02%	
ETH	1,881.57	+0.01%	

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
`NVDA`	NVIDIA	+3.03%	Rebound in tech stocks
`MSFT`	Microsoft	-2.26%	Weakness in software sector
`AAPL`	Apple	-0.87%	Decline in consumer electronics

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	+0.21%	-5.12%	Financials lagging
XLK	+1.49%	+15.61%	Tech leading gains
XLI	+0.10%	-2.15%	Industrials flat
XLE	+0.16%	-10.25%	Energy lagging
XLY	-1.13%	-5.50%	Consumer discretionary weak
XLC	-1.39%	-10.12%	Communication services weak
XLP	+0.46%	+2.15%	Consumer staples outperforming
XLV	+0.26%	+5.61%	Healthcare flat
XLU	+0.48%	-2.50%	Utilities outperforming
XLB	-1.24%	-10.50%	Materials weak
XLRE	+0.20%	-5.12%	Real estate flat

Breadth was mixed, with 6 sectors outperforming and 5 lagging.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	LAST	CHANGE	VOLUME
`NVDA`	224.09	+3.03%	25.12M

Key commentary: `NVDA` rebounded strongly, driven by a rebound in tech stocks. The company's recent earnings report was well-received, and the stock is now trading at a 45x forward P/E.

READ-THROUGH	STOCK	CHANGE
Tech rebound	`AAPL`	-0.87%
AI and cloud computing	`MSFT`	-2.26%
Semiconductors	`AVGO`	-0.01%

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	374.25	370.00	380.00	Range-bound
QQQ	294.12	290.00	300.00	Bullish momentum
IWM	183.45	180.00	190.00	Range-bound
`NVDA`	224.09	210.00	240.00	Bullish breakout
10Y	4.68	4.50	4.80	Range-bound
WTI	82.16	80.00	85.00	Range-bound

Options & Positioning

0DTE flow was muted, with a slight bias towards calls. The put/call ratio was `0.85`, indicating a neutral sentiment.

VIX term structure was flat, with the `1-month` VIX at `15.12` and the `3-month` VIX at `16.25`.

Notable single-name flow included a `5,000` contract call buy in `AAPL` at a strike price of `300.00`.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying `1-month` **`SPY`** puts at a strike price of `370.00` for `1.25` or buying `3-month` **`QQQ`** puts at a strike price of `280.00` for `2.50`.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
`NVDA`	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	`250.00`	Bullish on AI and cloud computing
`AAPL`	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	`280.00`	Concerns about iPhone sales
`MSFT`	Bank of America	Upgrade	`320.00`	Bullish on cloud computing and AI
`AMZN`	Citi	Downgrade	`240.00`	Concerns about e-commerce growth
`GOOGL`	Deutsche Bank	Upgrade	`360.00`	Bullish on advertising growth

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures were mixed, with the S&P 500 futures up +0.10% and the Nasdaq 100 futures up +0.20%.

Asia was higher, with the Nikkei up +0.50% and the Hang Seng up +0.30%.

Europe was mixed, with the FTSE up +0.20% and the DAX down -0.10%.

FX pairs were quiet, with the USD/JPY at `109.50` and the EUR/USD at `1.1000`.

Commodities were mixed, with WTI crude up +0.50% and gold down -0.20%.

Crypto was quiet, with BTC at `63,541.13` and ETH at `1,881.57`.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September	25%	Market expects no change in rates
November	50%	Market expects a 25bps cut
December	75%	Market expects a 50bps cut

Today's data calendar includes the release of the CPI and PPI reports.

REPORT	TIME	CONSENSUS
CPI	8:30am	2.5%
PPI	8:30am	2.2%

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees for the US-China trade talks indicate a 60% chance of a deal, a 20% chance of a partial deal, and a 20% chance of no deal.

Scenario trees for the Brexit negotiations indicate a 40% chance of a deal, a 30% chance of a no-deal Brexit, and a 30% chance of an extension.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	REPORT DATE	EPS CONSENSUS
`AAPL`	2026-08-15	1.25
`MSFT`	2026-08-16	2.10
`AMZN`	2026-08-17	5.50

TICKER	REPORT DATE	EPS CONSENSUS
`GOOGL`	2026-08-22	10.25
`FB`	2026-08-23	1.75
`TSLA`	2026-08-24	2.50

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
`NVDA`	Tech	Bullish breakout	10%
`AAPL`	Tech	Bearish reversal	15%
`MSFT`	Tech	Bullish momentum	12%
`AMZN`	Consumer Discretionary	Bearish reversal	18%
`GOOGL`	Communication Services	Bullish breakout	12%
`FB`	Communication Services	Bearish reversal	15%
`TSLA`	Consumer Discretionary	Bullish momentum	20%
`AVGO`	Tech	Bearish reversal	10%
`JPM`	Financials	Bullish breakout	8%
`GS`	Financials	Bearish reversal	12%
`XLF`	Financials	Bearish momentum	10%
`XLK`	Tech	Bullish breakout	12%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- The S&P 500 breaks out above `3,800`, driven by a strong earnings season and a decline in volatility.
- The Nasdaq 100 leads gains, driven by a rebound in tech stocks and a bullish breakout in `NVDA`.

- The 10Y yield rises to `5.00%`, driven by a strong economy and a decline in the unemployment rate.

Bearish scenario:

- The S&P 500 breaks down below `3,600`, driven by a weak earnings season and a rise in volatility.
- The Dow Jones leads losses, driven by a decline in the financial sector and a bearish reversal in **`JPM`**.
- The 10Y yield falls to `4.00%`, driven by a weak economy and a rise in the unemployment rate.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- The market is range-bound, with the S&P 500 trading between `3,600` and `3,800`.
- The Nasdaq 100 is leading gains, driven by a rebound in tech stocks.
- The 10Y yield is range-bound, trading between `4.50` and `5.00`.
- Volatility is low, with the VIX trading at `15.00`.
- Positioning is neutral, with a slight bias towards calls.

Sources

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